CASE STUDY:
Grove Central.

A 402-unit Coconut Grove tower, a social-media budget, and a conclusion the client reached on their own.

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01 · WHY THIS PAPER IS SHORT

WE'RE ONLY GOING TO TELL YOU WHAT WE *can prove.*

Most case studies in this industry are unfalsifiable. Ours is built the opposite way: every number below is either **publicly reported**, **attributed to the client in their own words**, or **measured directly in our ad accounts** – and we label which is which.

Where we don't have a defensible number, we say so rather than reaching for one. You should hold every vendor to this standard, including us.

PUBLIC	CLIENT-STATED	OUR MEASUREMENT
Reported in trade press or public filings. Verifiable without us.	Greystar's own words. Quoted exactly, never paraphrased.	From ad platforms we ran. Stated as ours, never inflated into theirs.

02 · THE BUILDING

402 UNITS. TRANSIT-ORIENTED. OPENED *January 2024.*

THE ASSET

Grove Central Residences, Coconut Grove, Miami. 402 units above a Metrorail station, with ground-floor retail. Developed by Terra and Grass River Property; managed by Greystar.

WORTH NOTING

The building includes **workforce and co-living units** alongside market-rate. This was not a luxury-only lease-up – the same engine ran across price points.

Source: public reporting (Florida YIMBY, The Real Deal, Commercial Observer, 2023–2024). Independently verifiable.

03 · WHAT THE CLIENT SAID

THEY CONNECTED THE DOTS. *Not us.*

Greystar reviewed their South Florida portfolio and identified two buildings outperforming the rest. We were not part of that analysis. It reached us afterward.

"Our two highest-performing lease-ups are Metro Edgewater & Grove Central. Neither used apartments.com 'Diamond Plus,' and SEM spend was south of $7,000 at both. The only thing those two properties have in common is they use THOMAS."

REGIONAL MARKETING LEAD · GREYSTAR SOUTH FLORIDA PORTFOLIO

Read this precisely. SEM means paid search only – not total marketing spend, not content, not our fee. "South of $7,000 at both" means at each property, not combined. No time period is stated, so none should be inferred. And the client asserts a *correlation he observed* – two buildings, one common variable. He does not claim causation, and neither do we.

04 · WHAT WE WERE ACTUALLY HIRED TO DO

SOCIAL MEDIA.
That's it.

We were not hired to run paid media, build the funnel, or own leasing performance. We were engaged for **social content**: shoot the property, build the feed, post it.

Looking at the paid campaigns, we could see they weren't converting. So we began running ads ourselves – roughly **$300 a month** of spend, on our own initiative. Nobody asked us to, and we didn't see the property's total marketing numbers until well after the fact.

Social	~$300	Same day
WHAT WE WERE HIRED FOR	MONTHLY AD SPEND WE RAN, UNREQUESTED	FROM WEAK AD TO REPLACEMENT

We include this because it's the most useful thing in the paper. The result did not come from a large budget. It came from the content and the speed of the loop – which is the part that transfers to your building.

EVERY NUMBER, LABELED BY *where it came from.*

This is everything we can defend, in one place. Source column follows the labeling from page one – public, client-stated, or our own measurement.

METRIC	RESULT	SOURCE	CONTEXT
Units / building type	**402**	Public	Coconut Grove, transit-oriented, opened Jan 2024.
Ad spend we ran	**~$300/mo**	Ours	Unrequested – we saw the paid campaigns underperforming.
SEM (paid search) spend	**<$7,000**	Client-stated	At each property, Grove Central and Metro Edgewater, per Greystar: "south of $7,000 at both."
Apartments.com Diamond Plus spend	**$0**	Client-stated	Neither property used it.
Leads generated	**1,417+**	Ours	Measured in the ad accounts we operated.
Cost per lead	**~$10.43**	Ours	Measured in the ad accounts we operated.
Metro Edgewater Instagram followers	**4,586 → 6,109**	Ours	Oct to Dec 2023, from the monthly social reports sent to Greystar.
Metro Edgewater organic engagement	**8.4%**	Ours	Per impression, Dec 2023 report.
Metro Edgewater CPL	**$2.54**	Ours	Concurrent Greystar lease-up, same approach.
Leased in month one	**30%+**	Ours	Share of the building leased within the first month after opening.
Impressions generated	**4.6M+**	Ours	Across the campaign.
People reached	**444K+**	Ours	Unique reach, campaign total.
Final residential occupancy	**Not verified**	–	See "Where the evidence stops" below – we don't have a defensible number and won't invent one.

What we will not claim: we do not attribute signed leases to these leads. We did not control the leasing office, tour conversion, or pricing, and any vendor who tells you they can isolate their contribution to a signed lease is overstating what the data supports. Lead cost, volume, reach, and impressions are ours. The lease-up outcome is Greystar's to characterize – which they did, above.

06 · WHY IT WORKED

ONE TEAM MEANT THE LOOP CLOSED THE *same day.*

THE USUAL CHAIN

An ad stops converting. Rebrief the photographer, wait on a quote, schedule a shoot, wait on the edit, hand it to the media buyer, relaunch. Months pass. The building sits.

WHAT HAPPENED HERE

The team shooting the property was also cutting the ads and watching the leasing report. A weak hook got swapped and relaunched the same day, from footage already in hand.

That's the transferable part. Not the budget, not the market, not the building. The speed at which creative can be corrected once the same team owns the content and the campaign.

07 · WHERE THE EVIDENCE STOPS

WHAT WE *don't* KNOW

Stated plainly, because a proof document that only contains good news isn't proof:

FINAL RESIDENTIAL OCCUPANCY

Widely-circulated "95% leased" figures in public reporting refer to the building's **retail** space, not residential. We do not have a verified residential occupancy curve, so we don't quote one.

CONCESSIONS

We have seen it claimed that the lease-up ran without concessions. We cannot verify that from a primary source, so we make no concession claim.

TIME TO STABILIZATION

We do not have a documented stabilization date we can stand behind. Greystar characterized the pace in their own words; we let that stand rather than attaching a number to it.

ATTRIBUTION

Two buildings is a pattern, not a controlled study. The client's observation is strong precisely because he made it independently – not because it isolates a variable.

WHAT WOULD THIS LOOK LIKE *on your communities?*

On a short call we map the system to your properties: which communities first, what each one needs, and what it costs. Pricing is set per property on that call.

The deck

Who we are, the dashboard, how we run a portfolio.

JAMESTHOMASPHOTO-RGB.GITHUB.IO/THOMAS-SALES-KIT/THOMAS-DECK-PROPERTY-MANAGERS.PDF

Case studies

Grove Central and Metro Edgewater. One page each.

JAMESTHOMASPHOTO-RGB.GITHUB.IO/THOMAS-SALES-KIT/THOMAS-CASE-STUDIES.PDF

The work

Real feeds we run, plus our photo and drone work.

JAMESTHOMASPHOTO-RGB.GITHUB.IO/THOMAS-SALES-KIT/SHOWCASE.HTML

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